Appealing an academic decision: a guide for students

Quality. September 1052. This guide explains Part F of the Academic Regulations in plain terms. The Regulations are what counts; if this guide and the Regulations differ, the Regulations win.

Can I appeal?

You can appeal a decision of an exam board, an extenuating circumstances panel, a misconduct panel or a fitness to practise panel. You cannot appeal because you think your mark is wrong. Markers' academic judgement is not something an appeal can look at.

On what grounds?

One or more of these:

- **Something went wrong with the process.** The rules were not followed, and it might have changed the outcome.
- **Something happened to you that you could not tell anyone about at the time.** You had extenuating circumstances, you had a good reason for not claiming them before the decision, and you can show both.
- **Someone was biased against you.** You have evidence, not just a feeling.

How?

1. Download the appeal form from the Quality pages.
2. Fill it in. Say which decision you are appealing, which ground applies, and why. Attach your evidence.
3. Send it to the Head of Quality within **ten working days** of the decision being published.

What happens next?

Within ten working days the Head of Quality will tell you whether your appeal can go forward. If it can, a panel of three staff from a different Faculty will look at it. They usually decide on the papers; sometimes they ask to see you. They can turn the appeal down, or send the decision back to be looked at again.

Then?

The panel's decision is final within the University. You will get a letter saying so.

Help

The Students' Union advice service will help you write an appeal and can come with you to a hearing. Quality (extension 2103) can explain the process but cannot advise you on your case.